

XBMC on your HTPC

What's the point of owning an HTPC if your software is not built to operate as one? <http://bit.ly/oLKPEM>

Microsoft still loves Windows

Why Microsoft will never drop the Windows moniker. Follow the link for more... <http://bit.ly/qJSLZ>

Online filing of complaints

Digitalisation helps quicker redressal of issues

Kapil Rustagi

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Samar Kachwaha is a tech-savvy corporate consultant, and was upset with the service provided by his mobile company. Although he tried to bring them to book, he couldn't really do anything more than send them a legal notice. After frequent visits to the consumer court, which were taking a heavy toll on his pocket and career, like many other litigants before him, he just gave up the fight mid-way.

The total number of consumer complaints in India have increased by 50 per cent since 2005 – that's about 35 lakh

complaints as of April 2011. Quite aptly, the government is now under tremendous pressure to find a solution that will help clear the massive backlog of consumer complaints. Digitilisation is one such solution that promises to bring justice to harried consumers, and transparency to the system.

Soon, if all goes well, you will be able to e-file consumer complaints against brands. The government recently implemented a technology solution to enable

this, and soon consumers will be able to file reports online. The very nature of the online medium will also put more pressure on companies to reply online in order to maintain their reputations. It's a ray of hope for petty claim applicants – who feel short-changed by these companies. ■

COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

Laptops

Dell executives are not extending the warranty of my dell Inspiron 1464

I bought a Dell Inspiron 1464 laptop a year back. I had paid for a warranty of another year a month back (when it was under warranty). But it's been a month and my warranty status on the web site hasn't been updated yet. On contacting Dell representatives, I was told by an executive that it would be done. Another representative took all my information and apologised saying that they were doing all this quickly.

Before upgrading my warranty, they told me that 10 days after paying for the warranty, the status would be updated. But it's not been done yet. I have all the email sent by the particular representative who was dealing with me. So please kindly suggest what to do.

Contacted by: Soubhagya Ranjan Jena

Answer By Consumermate:

Dear Ranjan,

There's no need to panic as you have indicated that you have all the documents. You just need to push them to do their bit of work. Simply write them an email and a letter sent through registered post giving them a final call to update the required status, failing which consumer case and police complaints would be filed. If they don't do the same, you can then file a consumer complaint. Also try to reach them through social networking sites like Facebook or Twitter.



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